

Capture the Silver Flag

FAQ

Sno.	Question	Answer
1	Are we required to participate, or is this optional?	Participation in this pre-hackathon challenge is mandatory and will contribute to the final hackathon score.
2	What exactly is Capture a Silver Flag? Is it an innovation or POC challenge?	It is an innovation-plus-POC challenge. Teams are expected to identify a meaningful CSR problem, propose a Cisco-powered solution, and build a proof of concept that demonstrates the core idea.
3	How much will this pre-hackathon challenge contribute to the final hackathon score?	The exact contribution to the final score will be announced when teams come to the Cisco campus for the in-person hackathon.
4	Do we need to choose only one theme, or can our idea combine multiple themes?	Teams should choose one primary theme for judging clarity. The solution may touch another theme, but the pitch should clearly state the main theme and the primary problem being solved.
5	What happens if two teams submit similar ideas?	Similar ideas are allowed. Teams will be judged on problem understanding, viability, quality of execution, Cisco relevance, innovation in approach, POC strength, scalability, and impact.
6	What does “Cisco-powered” mean?	“Cisco-powered” means Cisco technology should play a meaningful role in the solution architecture. This may include networking, security, observability, collaboration APIs, or other Cisco products. It should not be just a name-drop.
7	Are mock Cisco integrations acceptable?	Yes. Mock integrations are acceptable if they are clearly explained. Teams should show which Cisco product or API would be used in a real deployment and what is being simulated in the POC.
8	Can we use simulated data?	Yes. Simulated or synthetic data is acceptable, especially for disaster response, civic engagement, and wildlife scenarios where real data may be unavailable or sensitive. Teams should clearly mention when data is simulated.
9	How domain-deep do teams need to be? Is there extra point for that?	Teams are not expected to be domain experts, but they should show genuine understanding of the users, pain points, constraints, and expected impact.
10	Do we need backend code, or can the demo be frontend plus mocked data?	A frontend-only demo with mocked data is acceptable if it clearly proves the core workflow. However, teams with a working backend, API, or data flow will be scored accordingly, especially if the architecture is clear.

11	Are pre-built libraries or templates allowed?	Yes. Standard libraries, frameworks, UI templates, and starter kits are allowed. Teams must clearly explain what they built themselves and how the solution works.
12	Are we allowed to use open-source libraries or existing code?	Yes. Open-source libraries and existing code may be used if the license allows it and proper attribution is provided. The team's own contribution and integration should be clear.
13	What should be included in the 3-slide pitch deck?	There is no required order. The deck should clearly convey the problem, target users, impact, solution, user flow, Cisco-powered architecture, and any other important callouts.
14	Is there a required pitch deck template?	No. The slide deck can be prepared in the team's own style.
15	What happens if our GitHub repo is incomplete?	The team will be judged based on the evidence available at submission time. Missing code, setup instructions, demo links, or documentation may impact the score accordingly.
16	Should the GitHub repo be public or private?	The GitHub repository should be private. At the time of final submission, provide admin rights to Rajul Bhadouria - https://github.com/bobybhadouria143
17	Can we update the GitHub repo after the submission deadline?	Updates after the deadline will not be considered for judging. Teams should treat the deadline as the final submission point.
18	What should we do if the Box upload fails or the file is too large?	Please ensure the video is in 720p resolution and does not exceed 2 GB. If you face any issues, inform the organizers immediately before the deadline, include a screenshot or error details, and share an alternate accessible link if allowed. Teams should not wait until the last minute to upload large files.
19	What should the demo include?	The demo submission should include a 5-minute video pitch and demonstration that covers the following elements: - Project Name - GitHub Repository URL - Summary of the project, focusing on the core concept and value proposition - Technology Stack - Showcase of the demonstration of the core user experience, which should be a functional or mock user interface that simulates the main user workflow. This should be a visual presentation, such as an HTML/JavaScript mock UX or a functional demo of the core workflow The demo video should clearly showcase the project's main features and pitch and is not expected to be a fully working end-to-end application.

20	What should be included in the GitHub repository submission?	The GitHub repository should be private and include the following: - A README file containing the project title and summarization - The Architecture Decision Record (ADR), limited to 1 to 2 pages focusing on major architectural decisions - Submit a concise set of architecture diagrams (e.g., 2 to 4) that effectively illustrate the major architectural components and workflows, such as sequence diagrams, class diagrams, or other relevant views - Code used for the demo of the project, for example HTML/JavaScript
21	What is the recommended length and focus for the Architecture Decision Record (ADR) in GitHub?	The ADR should be concise, limited to 1 to 2 pages, focusing strictly on the major architectural decisions made during the project.